



TradePulse – Practical User Flows & UI Design Guide

Version: 1.0

Date: September 2026

Platforms: PWA + Flutter Mobile App

1. Trader User Flow (Primary User)

User Profile: Thandi, Spaza Shop Owner

- Age: 34
- Location: Soweto
- Business: Thandi's Spaza (home-based shop)
- Smartphone: Android (Samsung Galaxy A14)
- Digital literacy: Low (uses WhatsApp, Facebook, TikTok)
- Connectivity: Intermittent 4G, frequent offline periods
- Languages: isiZulu (primary), English (basic)

Flow 1: First-Time Onboarding (5–7 minutes)

Step 1: Landing Page / App Store

[TradePulse Logo]

"Record sales with your voice. Know your business."

[Get Started Button] [Watch Demo Video]

Features:

- ✓ Voice recording in isiZulu/English
- ✓ Works offline
- ✓ Free for traders



Step 2: Phone Registration

"Let's set up your business"

[Phone Number Input: +27 ___ ___ -- ___]
[Send OTP Button]
"We'll send a code to verify your number"



Step 3: OTP Verification
"Enter the code we sent you"
[_] [_] [_] [_] [_] [_]
[Verify Button] [Resend Code]
Auto-detects OTP from SMS (Android)



Step 4: Business Profile Setup
"Tell us about your business"
Business Name: [Thandi's Spaza]
Location: [Soweto, Orlando West] (GPS auto-fill)
Business Type: [Spaza Shop ▼]
Years in Business: [3 years ▼]
[Continue Button]



Step 5: Product Catalogue Setup (Optional)
"Add your top 5 products" (Skip for now)
[Add Product Button]
Product 1: [Bread] Stock: [^20]
Product 2: [Kota] Stock: [^15]
Product 3: [Cooldrink] Stock: [^30]
[Skip & Continue Button]



Step 6: PIN Setup
"Create a 4-digit PIN for quick access"
[●] [●] [●] [●]
"Keep this secret. Don't share with anyone."



Step 7: Tutorial (3 slides)

Slide 1: "Record sales by voice"

[Microphone Icon] "Just say what you sold"

Slide 2: "See your daily sales"

[Dashboard Icon] "Track your business growth"

Slide 3: "Get ready for funding"

[Passport Icon] "Build your business profile"

[Get Started Button]



Step 8: Home Dashboard (First View)

Welcome, Thandi! 🇿🇦

Today's Sales: R0

[Record Transaction Button - Large, Blue]

Quick Tips:

"Start by recording your first sale!"

[Voice Tutorial Button]

UI Design Notes:

- **Large buttons** (min 48×48 dp for touch targets)
- **High contrast** (blue primary, white background)
- **Simple language** (Grade 6–8 reading level)
- **Visual icons** (microphone, dashboard, passport)
- **Progress indicators** (Step 1 of 8, etc.)
- **Skip options** for non-critical steps

Flow 2: Daily Transaction Recording (30–60 seconds)

Home Dashboard

Today: Wed, 16 Sep 2026

Today's Sales

R 140.00

4 transactions

[🇿🇦 RECORD TRANSACTION] (Large Blue Button)

Recent Activity:

- Sold 4 kotas - R140 (2 min ago)
- Sold 2 cooldrinks - R30 (15 min ago)
- Bought 10 bread - R150 (1 hour ago)

[View All Transactions]

↓ (Tap Record Transaction)

Record Transaction

"How do you want to record?"

☒ Voice

"Speak now"



Text

"Type it"

[Cancel Button]

↓ (Tap Voice)

Voice Recording

[Large Microphone Icon - Pulsing Animation]

"I sold 4 kotas at R35 each"

[Tap to Stop]

Listening... (waveform animation)

[Cancel] [Use Text Instead]

↓ (After 3-5 seconds)

Confirm Transaction

"Did you sell this?"

Type: [Sale ▼]

Product: [Kota]

Quantity: [^4]

Price Each: [R35.00]

Total: [R140.00]

[Edit Details] [✓ Confirm & Save]

"This will update your stock automatically"

↓ (Tap Confirm)

Success Confirmation

✓ Transaction Recorded!

Sold: 4 kotas × R35 = R140

Remaining stock: 11 kotas

[Record Another] [View Dashboard]

Auto-returns to dashboard after 3 seconds

UI Design Notes:

- **Voice-first:** Microphone button is largest and most prominent
- **Confirmation step:** Prevents errors, builds trust
- **Stock feedback:** Shows remaining inventory immediately
- **Quick actions:** "Record Another" for busy periods
- **Offline indicator:** Shows if transaction will sync later

Flow 3: Viewing Dashboard & Reports (1–2 minutes)

Dashboard

Welcome back, Thandi! ☒

This Week

R 2,450.00

▲ 15% vs last week

This Month

R 8,920.00

▲ 22% vs last month

Top Products (This Week):

1. ☒ Bread - R850 (34 sales)
2. ☒ Kota - R620 (18 sales)
3. ☒ Cooldrink - R480 (32 sales)

Low Stock Alert: ⚠

- Bread (5 left)
- Sugar (3 left)

[View Full Report] [Generate Passport]

↓ (Tap View Full Report)

Sales Report

Period: [This Month ▼]

[Bar Chart: Daily Sales Trend]

Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
R400	R520	R380	R610	R490	R720	R550

Total Revenue: R8,920

Total Expenses: R6,240

Profit: R2,680

Transactions: 127

Average per day: R288

[Export PDF] [Share via WhatsApp]

↓ (Tap Generate Passport)

Readiness Passport

"Your business profile for banks & suppliers"

Business: Thandi's Spaza

Since: 2023

Location: Soweto, Orlando West

Trading History:

- 6 months of verified sales
- Average monthly revenue: R8,500
- Consistency score: 85/100 ✓

Stock Turnover:

- Bread: 4.2x/month
- Kota: 3.8x/month

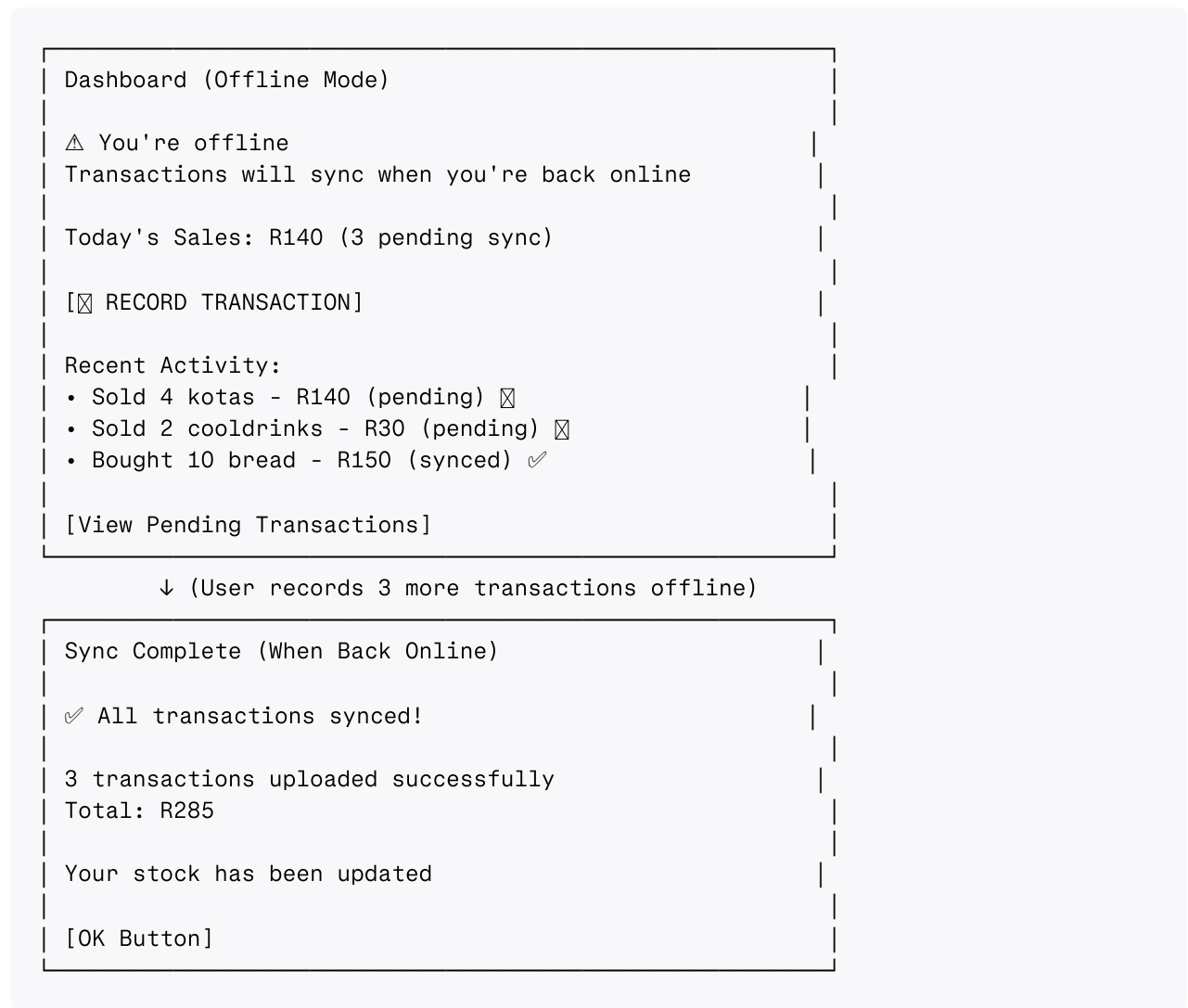
[Download PDF] [Share with Bank]

"This passport can help you apply for funding"

UI Design Notes:

- **Visual hierarchy:** Big numbers at top, details below
- **Charts:** Simple bar/line charts, not complex
- **Color coding:** Green for growth, red for alerts
- **Export options:** PDF, WhatsApp share (most common)
- **Passport positioning:** Framed as opportunity, not requirement

Flow 4: Offline Mode (Seamless Experience)



UI Design Notes:

- **Clear offline indicator:** Yellow warning banner
- **Pending status:** Shows which transactions are queued
- **Auto-sync:** No manual action required
- **Success confirmation:** Reassures user data is safe

2. Distributor User Flow (B2B Customer)

User Profile: Michael, Field Sales Manager

- **Company:** Tiger Brands Distribution
- **Role:** Field Sales Manager
- **Territory:** Soweto, Orlando, Diepkloof
- **Responsibility:** 150 spaza shops

- **Device:** Company laptop + Android tablet
- **Goal:** Improve order collection, reduce stock-outs

Flow 1: Distributor Dashboard (Desktop)

TradePulse Partner Portal - Distributor

Welcome, Michael (Tiger Brands)
Territory: Soweto West (150 retailers)

Active Retailers
127 / 150
85% adoption rate

This Week's Orders
R 45,280
▲ 18% vs last week

Top Products (Your Territory):
1. White Bread 700g - 2,340 units
2. Maize Meal 2.5kg - 1,890 units
3. Sugar 2kg - 1,560 units

Low Stock Alerts (Retailers):

- Thandi's Spaza - Bread (5 left)
- John's Cafe - Sugar (3 left)
- Maria's Store - Maize Meal (8 left)

[View All Retailers] [Generate Report]

↓ (Click View All Retailers)

Retailer List

Search: [Thandi's Spaza]
Filter: [All ▼] [Low Stock ▼] [High Volume ▼]

Thandi's Spaza [View Details]
Orlando West • Active 2 hours ago
Monthly orders: R3,200
Low stock: Bread, Sugar
Last order: 3 days ago

John's Cafe [View Details]
Diepkloof • Active 5 hours ago
Monthly orders: R4,800

Low stock: Sugar, Rice
Last order: 1 day ago

[\[Export to CSV\]](#)
[\[Send Bulk Promotion\]](#)

↓ (Click View Details on Thandi's Spaza)

Retailer Profile: Thandi's Spaza Contact: +27 12 345 6789 Address: Orlando West, Soweto Owner: Thandi Mkhize <table border="1"> <tr> <td>Trading Performance</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Avg monthly orders: R3,200</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Order frequency: 2.3x/week</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Consistency score: 85/100</td> </tr> </table> Current Stock (Your Products): • White Bread 700g: 5 units (LOW) ▲ • Maize Meal 2.5kg: 12 units • Sugar 2kg: 3 units (LOW) ▲ Order History (Last 30 days): • 13 Sep: Bread x20, Sugar x10 - R520 • 10 Sep: Maize Meal x15, Bread x15 - R680 • 07 Sep: Sugar x20, Bread x25 - R740 [Send Restock Reminder] [Create Order] [View Readiness Passport]	Trading Performance	Avg monthly orders: R3,200	Order frequency: 2.3x/week	Consistency score: 85/100
Trading Performance				
Avg monthly orders: R3,200				
Order frequency: 2.3x/week				
Consistency score: 85/100				

UI Design Notes:

- **Data-rich but scannable:** Key metrics in cards
- **Actionable insights:** Low stock alerts with direct actions
- **Search & filter:** Essential for managing 100+ retailers
- **Export options:** CSV for Excel analysis, CRM integration

Flow 2: Sending Bulk Promotion

Send Promotion
"Create a promotion for your retailers"
Promotion Name: [Bread Special - September]
Product: [White Bread 700g ▼]
Discount: [15% off ▼]

Valid Until: [30 Sep 2026]

Target Retailers:

☒ All retailers in territory (127)

☐ Filter by: [Low stock bread ▼] (23 retailers)

☐ Select manually (0 selected)

Message (WhatsApp):

"Hi! Special offer: 15% off White Bread this week.
Order now via TradePulse!"

[Preview]

[Send to 127 Retailers]

Cost: R9.65 (127 × R0.076 per message)

↓ (Tap Send)

Promotion Sent!

✓ Sent to 127 retailers

Delivery status:

• Delivered: 98 (77%)

• Pending: 29 (23%)

• Failed: 0 (0%)

[View Analytics]

[Send Another]

UI Design Notes:

- **Cost transparency:** Shows WhatsApp message costs
- **Targeting options:** Bulk, filtered, or manual selection
- **Delivery tracking:** Real-time status updates
- **Quick iteration:** "Send Another" for frequent use

3. Bank/Funder User Flow (B2B Customer)

User Profile: Priya, SME Lending Manager

- **Company:** African Bank
- **Role:** SME Lending Manager
- **Focus:** Township MSMEs, alternative credit scoring
- **Goal:** Assess creditworthiness of informal businesses
- **Device:** Desktop + occasional mobile

Flow 1: Business Assessment Dashboard

TradePulse Partner Portal - Bank

Welcome, Priya (African Bank)

Portfolio: 342 assessed businesses

Approved Loans (via TradePulse)

28 loans

R 1.8M total

96% repayment rate

Pending Applications

15 businesses

R 890K requested

Risk Distribution:

- Low Risk: 145 (42%)
- Medium Risk: 162 (47%)
- High Risk: 35 (11%)

Recent Applications:

- Thandi's Spaza - R50K (Low Risk) ✓
- John's Cafe - R75K (Medium Risk) ☒
- Maria's Store - R30K (High Risk) ✗

[View All Applications] [Generate Report]

↓ (Click on Thandi's Spaza)

Business Assessment: Thandi's Spaza

Application: R50,000 working capital loan

Purpose: Stock purchase (bulk buying)

Term: 12 months

TradePulse Readiness Score

85/100 - LOW RISK ✓

Trading History (6 months):

- Avg monthly revenue: R8,500
- Revenue trend: ▲ 15% growth
- Consistency: 92% (missed 2 days)
- Total transactions: 743

Stock Turnover:

- Bread: 4.2x/month (excellent)
- Kota: 3.8x/month (good)
- Cooldrinks: 5.1x/month (excellent)

Repayment Capacity:

- Estimated monthly profit: R2,680
- Proposed installment: R4,500/month
- DTI ratio: 59% (acceptable)

[Download Full Report] [Approve Loan] [Decline]
[Request More Info]

UI Design Notes:

- **Risk scoring:** Clear visual indicator (color + score)
- **Decision support:** All key data on one screen
- **Action buttons:** Approve/Decline/Request Info prominent
- **Download option:** For internal credit committee review

Flow 2: Portfolio Monitoring

Portfolio Monitoring

Filter: [All Businesses ▼] [Risk: All ▼]

Date Range: [Last 30 days ▼]

Portfolio Health

Active: 315 / 342 (92%)

At Risk: 18 (5%)

Inactive: 9 (3%)

Alerts (Requires Action):

⚠ 5 businesses with declining revenue (>20%)

⚠ 8 businesses with irregular trading

⚠ 3 businesses haven't synced in 14+ days

Top Performers (Low Risk):

1. Thandi's Spaza - Score: 92/100

2. John's Cafe - Score: 88/100

3. Maria's Store - Score: 85/100

[Export Portfolio Report] [Set Up Alerts]

UI Design Notes:

- **Proactive monitoring:** Alerts for at-risk businesses
- **Portfolio view:** Aggregate health metrics
- **Drill-down:** Click to see individual business details

- **Export:** For regulatory reporting, internal reviews

4. Admin User Flow (Internal Team)

User Profile: David, System Administrator

- **Company:** TradePulse (internal)
- **Role:** System Administrator
- **Responsibilities:** User management, system monitoring, support
- **Device:** Desktop (primary), mobile (occasional)

Flow 1: Admin Dashboard



User Management

Search: [Thandi Mkhize]

Filter: [All Users ▼] [Status: All ▼]

Thandi Mkhize [View Profile]

Phone: +27 12 345 6789

Business: Thandi's Spaza

Status: Active ✓

Joined: 14 Sep 2026

Last active: 2 minutes ago

John Dlamini [View Profile]

Phone: +27 98 765 4321

Business: John's Cafe

Status: Suspended ⚠

Joined: 10 Aug 2026

Last active: 5 days ago

Actions:

[Bulk Suspend] [Bulk Activate] [Export Users]

[Send Announcement]

↓ (Click View Profile on Thandi)

User Profile: Thandi Mkhize

Contact Information:

- Phone: +27 12 345 6789
- Email: (not provided)
- Location: Orlando West, Soweto

Business Details:

- Name: Thandi's Spaza
- Type: Spaza Shop
- Since: 2023

Account Status:

- Status: Active ✓
- Plan: Free (Trader)
- Sponsored by: None

Activity Summary:

- Total transactions: 127
- Last transaction: 2 minutes ago
- Avg per week: 21 transactions

Support Tickets:

- #1247 - "Can't record voice" (Open)
- #1189 - "How to export report?" (Resolved)

Actions:

[Suspend Account]	[Reset PIN]	[Send Message]
[View Transaction History]	[Download Data]	

UI Design Notes:

- **Comprehensive view:** All user data in one place
- **Action buttons:** Suspend, reset, message clearly visible
- **Support integration:** Tickets linked to user profile
- **Audit trail:** Track admin actions for security

Flow 2: Support Ticket Management

Support Tickets

Filter: [All ▼] [Status: Open ▼] [Priority: All ▼]

#1247 - Can't record voice	[High]	[Open]
User: Thandi Mkhize (Thandi's Spaza)		
Created: 10:15 AM today		
"When I tap microphone, nothing happens"		
[View Details]	[Assign to Me]	

#1246 - Dashboard not loading	[Medium]	[Open]
User: John Dlamini (John's Cafe)		
Created: 09:42 AM today		
"Page shows blank screen"		
[View Details]	[Assign to Me]	

#1245 - How to change language	[Low]	[Open]
User: Maria Nkosi (Maria's Store)		
Created: Yesterday		
"I want isiZulu not English"		
[View Details]	[Assign to Me]	

Stats:

• Open: 23 • In Progress: 8 • Resolved: 156
• Avg response time: 2.3 hours

[Create New Ticket] [Export Tickets]

↓ (Click View Details on #1247)

Ticket #1247: Can't record voice

User: Thandi Mkhize (+27 12 345 6789)
Business: Thandi's Spaza
Priority: High
Status: Open
Assigned to: [Unassigned ▼]

Issue Description:
"When I tap microphone, nothing happens. I'm using Samsung Galaxy A14. This started this morning."

Device Info:

- Model: Samsung Galaxy A14
- OS: Android 13
- App version: 1.2.4
- Connection: 4G

Conversation:

Support (Auto): Thanks for reporting! We'll look into this. Can you try restarting the app?
10:18 AM

Thandi: I tried but still not working
10:25 AM

[Reply] [Mark as Resolved] [Escalate to Tech Team]

[Add Internal Note]

UI Design Notes:

- **Priority system:** High/Medium/Low for triage
- **Assignment workflow:** Tickets assigned to support agents
- **Conversation thread:** Full history visible
- **Device context:** Helps diagnose technical issues
- **SLA tracking:** Response time metrics

5. Key UI/UX Principles Across All Roles

For Traders (Mobile-First)

1. Large touch targets (min 48×48 dp)
2. High contrast (blue/white primary, red for alerts)
3. Simple language (Grade 6–8 reading level)
4. Visual icons (microphone, dashboard, passport)
5. Minimal text (show, don't tell)

6. **Offline-first** (clear status, auto-sync)
7. **Voice-first** (microphone button most prominent)
8. **Quick actions** (one-tap record, view dashboard)

For Partners (Desktop-First)

1. **Data-rich but scannable** (cards, charts, tables)
2. **Actionable insights** (alerts with direct actions)
3. **Search & filter** (essential for large datasets)
4. **Export options** (CSV, PDF for analysis)
5. **Bulk actions** (send promotions, manage portfolios)
6. **Role-based access** (distributor vs. bank views)
7. **Real-time updates** (live data, notifications)

For Admins (Desktop-First)

1. **Comprehensive views** (all data accessible)
2. **Audit trails** (track all actions)
3. **Bulk operations** (suspend, activate, message)
4. **Support integration** (tickets linked to users)
5. **System monitoring** (uptime, errors, performance)
6. **Security controls** (suspend, reset, export)
7. **Analytics dashboards** (usage, growth, churn)

6. Wireframe Summary

Trader Mobile App (5 Core Screens)

1. **Onboarding** (8 steps, 5–7 minutes)
2. **Home Dashboard** (today's sales, record button, recent activity)
3. **Record Transaction** (voice/text, confirmation, success)
4. **Reports** (weekly/monthly charts, top products, low stock)
5. **Passport** (business profile, trading history, download/share)

Partner Desktop Portal (5 Core Screens)

1. **Dashboard** (overview, alerts, key metrics)
2. **Retailer/Business List** (search, filter, bulk actions)
3. **Individual Profile** (detailed view, order history, passport)

4. Analytics (charts, trends, exports)
5. Actions (send promotions, create orders, approve loans)

Admin Console (5 Core Screens)

1. System Dashboard (status, stats, recent activity)
2. User Management (search, filter, view profiles)
3. Support Tickets (triage, assign, resolve)
4. Analytics (usage, growth, churn, revenue)
5. Settings (system config, roles, permissions)

This user flow documentation provides a complete picture of how TradePulse works for all stakeholders. The UI should prioritize **simplicity for traders, actionable insights for partners, and comprehensive control for admins.**



1. https://www.finmark.org.za/Publications/Informal_SMME_Support_Framework.pdf
2. <https://bfaglobal.com/digital-spazas/insights/how-credit-can-unlock-growth-and-contribute-to-the-financial-health-of-spazas-in-south-africas-informal-economy/>
3. <https://www.treasury.gov.za/POPIA/POPI Act 4 of 2013.pdf>